DIGITAL FORENSICS · OSINT INVESTIGATION REPORT

Operation Shadow Trace

Suspected Drug-Trafficking Logistics Operation — Training Simulation

Field	Detail
Participant name	«Your full name»
Participant ID	«Your Participant ID»
Assessment	Operation Shadow Trace — DF OSINT (90 min, 70 marks)
Case reference	OST/DF/2025/047 · Exhibit group BL-047
Report reference	DF-OSINT_Investigation_Report_<ParticipantID>
Report date	«date»
Report status	Fictional training simulation — all persons, shipments and findings are invented.
Submitted to	mohdzamri.osman@utm.my · Subject: Investigation Report

Statement: This report separates what the evidence supports from what remains uncertain. A matching username does not establish identity or criminal responsibility.

A. Evidence inventory

Two evidence files were supplied. The originals were never modified: each was hashed, copied to a working folder, and the copies re-hashed to confirm integrity. All analysis was performed on the copies.

#	Filename	Size (bytes)	SHA-256 (original = working copy)
1	Evidence_01_Confidential_Logistics_Report.pdf.pdf	3,031	95851D30DD9F5F54684FD93776E5593F7E80F5752CC1812CA2A0D290EE16DAD4
2	Evidence_02_Drug_Seizure_Examination_Report.pdf	31,718	C8119A0FCEA5EAF2EE8251F9F8CEF07F76779DC27175219BC63592299C26123F

Independent hashes were produced by team members (Adief, Alysha, Alawi, Hasya, Abi) and all agree with the values above, confirming the evidence is stable and unchanged.

Hash command used (repeatable):

```
Get-FileHash -Algorithm SHA256 "Evidence_01_Confidential_Logistics_Report.pdf.pdf"
Get-FileHash -Algorithm SHA256 "Evidence_02_Drug_Seizure_Examination_Report.pdf"
```

A supplementary artefact, sample_shipments.csv, was downloaded from the located repository. Recorded SHA-256: a3b4431eeb39a810b71e98bbc81ce3145c8f17cbd090c8860472b19904e7f056.

B. PDF findings (Evidence 01)

The identifier meridiantrace47 was recovered from four independent layers of Evidence 01. Multiple independent sources strongly corroborate the finding; it is not an artefact of a single field.

Layer	Location	Extraction method	Value recovered
1. Metadata	/ReviewerRef in the Info dictionary	base64 decode of bWVyaWRpYW50cmFjZTQ3	meridiantrace47
2. Metadata	/Keywords	plain-text read	Meridian Logistics; BL-047; NX-219; CR-081
3. Embedded file	reviewer_note.txt (object 10, /Type /EmbeddedFile)	extract + base64 decode	meridiantrace47
4. Hidden text	last Tj on page 1, drawn with 3 Tr (invisible render mode), 2 pt	PDF text extraction	meridiantrace47

Document metadata also recorded: /Producer (Meridian Logistics Services), /Author (Operations Assurance Unit), /Title (Internal Operations Review – MLS/OPS/2025/09-017), /Subject (Shipment record reconciliation, July–September 2025).

Exact commands / methods used:

```
exiftool "Evidence_01_Confidential_Logistics_Report.pdf.pdf"   # metadata, incl. ReviewerRef
pdftotext "Evidence_01_Confidential_Logistics_Report.pdf.pdf" -   # text layer (online converter also used)
pdfdetach -list "Evidence_01_Confidential_Logistics_Report.pdf.pdf"   # embedded attachments
pdfdetach -saveall "Evidence_01_Confidential_Logistics_Report.pdf.pdf"
qpdf --qdf --object-streams=disable in.pdf out.pdf ; pdf-parser -a in.pdf
python -c "import base64;print(base64.b64decode('bWVyaWRpYW50cmFjZTQ3').decode())"
```

Proof: the string meridiantrace47 appears by four different mechanisms (metadata field, embedded attachment, invisible 3 Tr text run, and consistent page content referencing BL-047 / NX-219 / CR-081). The hidden 3 Tr text run is the key concealed artefact — it does not render on the page yet survives in the content stream.

C. Automated OSINT (Sherlock, Maigret, user-scanner)

Commands run:

```
sherlock meridiantrace47
maigret meridiantrace47
user-scanner -u "meridiantrace47"   ;   user-scanner -e "meridiantrace47@gmail.com"
```

Automated results and hand verification:

Source	Automated hit	Hand verification outcome
GitHub	https://github.com/meridiantrace47	CONFIRMED. Account exists (API HTTP 200), uid 342993032, created 2026-10-15, 1 public repo.
GitHub Gist	https://gist.github.com/meridiantrace47	UNVERIFIED. Page loads but shows “No gists”; API public-gist count = 0. Treat as a lead only.
AniWorld	/user/profil/meridiantrace47	LEAD — page returns HTTP 200 but generic title; requires manual check.
TikTok	@meridiantrace47	LEAD — login/JS wall; could not verify by hand.
Threads	@meridiantrace47	LEAD — login wall; could not verify by hand.
Email (user-scanner)	meridiantrace47@gmail.com	NO HITS returned.

Verified profile URL: https://github.com/meridiantrace47

False positives excluded by hand:

• https://github.com/Meridian47 — a different, unrelated person (real name Stefan Mayr, created 2019, single unrelated repo). Name similarity only — EXCLUDED.

• meridian_trace47 — does not exist as a GitHub account (HTTP 404); it is only a self-declared alias inside the README.

Secondary identifiers surfaced in the repository README (self-declared, not independently verified): developer “Daniel M.”, current alias meridian_trace47, previous alias meridian47, contact meridiantrace47@gmail.com.

D. Shipment correlation (repository CSV vs Evidence 02)

Repository located: https://github.com/meridiantrace47/secret — files README.md and sample_shipments.csv (30 shipment rows).

Shipment IDs by group:

Group	Batch reference	Rows	Status	Alias column
Seized consignments	BL-047	SHP-2025-007, -014, -022, -029	Seized	meridiantrace47
Held consignments	NX-219	SHP-2025-004, -009, -011, -016, -019, -024, -026, -028	Held for review	meridian47
Routine deliveries	various BT-###	18 rows	Delivered	(none)

Confirmed matches — CSV vs Evidence 02 (all four BL-047 rows):

Exhibit	Shipment	Date	Txn ref	Declared goods	Simulated finding	Mass	Result
EX-01	SHP-2025-007	2025-07-16	TXN-1047	Office stationery	Methamphetamine	6.4 kg	✅ all fields match
EX-02	SHP-2025-014	2025-08-13	TXN-1054	Electronic accessories	Heroin	11.3 kg	✅ all fields match
EX-03	SHP-2025-022	2025-09-11	TXN-1062	Machine spare parts	Cocaine	2.9 kg	✅ all fields match
EX-04	SHP-2025-029	2025-09-18	TXN-1069	Printed manuals	MDMA	7.8 kg	✅ all fields match

The two sources also agree on batch reference BL-047, sender Meridian Trading and receiver Northstar Distribution, and the alias meridiantrace47 in the CSV ties directly to the recovered identifier.

Discrepancies recorded:

1. Declared-vs-actual weight gap — every BL-047 row has declared_weight_kg exceeding quantity_kg by exactly 5.0 kg (11.4/6.4; 16.3/11.3; 7.9/2.9; 12.8/7.8). A uniform, deliberate pattern rather than random error.

2. Declared goods ≠ actual item — each BL-047 row declares benign goods (stationery, accessories, spare parts, manuals) but records a controlled substance.

3. Two alias identities in one dataset — meridiantrace47 (BL-047, seized) vs meridian47 (NX-219, held); the README states meridian47 is the previous alias of the same developer.

4. NX-219 rows incomplete — weight/consignee fields blank, status Held for review, flag Pending; no confirmed contraband.

E. Conclusion

What the evidence supports

• The identifier meridiantrace47 was recovered and corroborated across four independent layers of Evidence 01 (metadata, embedded file, invisible 3 Tr text, and consistent page content).

• The identifier resolves to a real, hand-verified GitHub account (https://github.com/meridiantrace47) whose public repository "secret" contains a shipment dataset that attributes the four seized BL-047 consignments to the alias meridiantrace47.

• The repository CSV and Evidence 02 match exactly on all four BL-047 shipments (date, transaction reference, declared goods, finding, mass) and share the same batch, sender and receiver.

• The four consignments share a uniform +5.0 kg declared-vs-actual discrepancy and declare benign goods while recording controlled substances — a consistent pattern across the group.

What remains uncertain (limitations)

• An alias is not identity. A matching username does not prove that any person prepared, controlled, or knew about these records. Identity attribution and criminal responsibility are explicitly outside the scope of Evidence 02.

• meridian47, meridian_trace47, "Daniel M." and meridiantrace47@gmail.com are self-declared strings in a README, not independently verified and not confirmed to be one real person.

• The GitHub Gist, AniWorld, TikTok and Threads hits are unverified leads; the Meridian47 account is a verified false positive and is excluded.

• The entire dataset is a fictional training simulation; no physical items were seized or tested, and the substance findings are case assumptions. The GitHub account was created 2026-10-15, consistent with a training artefact. NX-219 records remain unresolved.

Finding, stated plainly: the evidence supports a consistent linkage between the recovered identifier, a verified public account, and four matched shipment records with a repeated declared-vs-actual discrepancy. It does NOT establish who is responsible, and no criminal conclusion is drawn from an alias, a repository or a shipment record alone.

Submission checklist

☑ Report has all five headings, A–E

☑ Both SHA-256 hashes recorded

☑ Recovered identifier and exact extraction command shown

☑ Verified profile URL included

☑ Matches and uncertainties stated separately

☐ Filename: DF-OSINT_Investigation_Report_<ParticipantID>.pdf (opened once before sending)

☐ Emailed to mohdzamri.osman@utm.my, subject "Investigation Report", name + Participant ID in body